

My Defender Will & Trust — Website Build Plan

How to use this document: Paste this entire file into Claude Code (or another agentic coding tool) as the project brief. Work through the phases in order. Do not skip Phase 0. At the end of each phase, run the acceptance checklist before moving on.

1. Product Overview

Product name: My Defender Will & Trust **What it is:** A web application that guides consumers through a stepped, interview-style process to create a state-compliant Last Will & Testament or Revocable Living Trust, available in all 50 states plus DC.

Two ways in:

- 1. **Direct subscribers** — users sign up and pay via Stripe.
- 2. **Partner-code users** — users enter an access code issued by an affiliated company (e.g., a law firm or tax resolution client base). The code unlocks the product at no charge (or a discount) and attributes the user to the issuing partner for reporting.

Business context (important for the builder): This product is a standalone, self-help legal document platform — deliberately **NOT** affiliated with or operated by a law firm, and not subject to bar association governance. The compliance posture is the “self-help software” model (like LegalZoom, Trust & Will, Nolo): the platform provides document preparation software and general legal information, never legal advice, and no attorney-client relationship is ever formed. At the end of the process, the platform **recommends the user have a licensed attorney in their state review the documents** before signing. An in-house/affiliated attorney review offering may be added in a later phase, but build nothing that depends on it now. Prominent self-help disclaimers are a core feature, not boilerplate.

2. Recommended Tech Stack

Layer	Choice	Why
		Full-stack, SSR for marketing

Framework	Next.js 15 (App Router, TypeScript)	pages, API routes for backend
Database	PostgreSQL via Supabase	Auth, row-level security, storage in one platform
Auth	Supabase Auth (email/password + magic link)	Simple, secure, handles sessions
Payments	Stripe (Checkout + Billing portal)	Subscriptions, coupons, webhooks
Document generation	<code>docx</code> npm library → DOCX, then convert to PDF (Gotenberg or <code>libreoffice-convert</code>)	Attorney-editable DOCX + client-facing PDF
File storage	Supabase Storage (private buckets, signed URLs)	Encrypted at rest, access-controlled
Email	Resend or Postmark	Transactional email (verification, document delivery, reminders)
Hosting	Vercel (app) + Supabase (data)	Fast to ship, scales
Styling	Tailwind CSS + shadcn/ui	Clean, professional UI fast

Branding direction: Professional, trustworthy legal-services aesthetic. Deep navy primary, gold/amber accent, generous whitespace, serif display font for headings (e.g., Source Serif or Lora), sans-serif body. Shield motif consistent with the “Defender” name.

3. Core User Flows

3.1 Entry & Authentication

- Landing page → “Get Started” → account creation (email + password, email verification required).
- After signup, a **gate screen** with two options:
 - **“I have an access code”** → code entry field → validates code → unlocks product, records partner attribution.

- **"Subscribe"** → Stripe Checkout → plan selection (see pricing below) → on webhook confirmation, unlock product.
- Returning users: standard login → dashboard.
- Password reset, email change, session management via Supabase Auth.

3.2 Pricing — Two Paths (configurable via admin, launch numbers below)

There are exactly two price paths at launch:

1. **Full price** — clients arriving without a code pay list price.
2. **Discount-code price** — clients with a code from an affiliated company pay a reduced price. The discount percentage/amount is set per code batch in admin.

Confirmed launch prices (owner-approved):

- **Will Package** (will + healthcare directive + HIPAA + financial POA): **\$159 individual / \$249 couples**
- **Trust Package** (revocable living trust + pour-over will + directives + POA + funding guide): **\$449 individual / \$579 couples**
- **Annual membership — SHIPS AT LAUNCH** (unlimited updates, secure document vault, annual estate checkup reminders, trust funding tracker, one free document shipment/year): **\$49/year**, offered at checkout and from the dashboard.
- **Discount-code price:** default **50% off list** → \$79 will / \$224 trust individual (per-batch configurable to a different percentage or flat price). Membership is full price for all users unless a code batch is explicitly configured to discount it.

Market reference points the above are positioned against: Trust & Will \$199 will / \$499 trust; LegalZoom ~\$99–149 will / \$399 trust; Nolo WillMaker \$109–219/yr all-inclusive subscription; Rocket Lawyer ~\$40/mo membership; FreeWill \$0.

3.3 The Stepped Interview (the heart of the product)

A wizard with a progress bar, autosave on every step, and the ability to leave and resume. Steps:

1. **State selection** — determines which legal ruleset applies to everything downstream. Show a notice if the user selects Louisiana (civil-law jurisdiction; see §5).
2. **Document type selection** — Will vs. Revocable Living Trust, with a short plain-

English comparison quiz ("Which is right for me?") that recommends one based on assets, probate-avoidance goals, and state.

3. **About you** — full legal name, DOB, address, marital status, prior marriages.
4. **Family** — spouse/partner, children (including minors, stepchildren, deceased children with issue), other dependents.
5. **Fiduciaries** — executor/personal representative + alternates; trustee/successor trustees (trust flow); guardians for minor children + alternates.
6. **Assets** (trust flow gets a deeper version) — real estate, financial accounts, business interests, personal property of significance.
7. **Distributions** — primary beneficiaries with percentages, contingent beneficiaries, per stirpes vs. per capita election (explained in plain English), specific bequests, disinheritance provisions, charitable gifts.
8. **Special provisions** — minor's trusts / age-staged distributions, pet care provisions, digital assets clause, no-contest clause where enforceable.
9. **Ancillary documents** — durable financial power of attorney, healthcare directive / living will, HIPAA authorization (state-specific forms).
10. **Review** — full plain-English summary of every choice; edit any section inline.
11. **Generate** — creates final documents and delivers a signing-ready package with **state-specific execution instructions** (see §5) plus a prominent recommendation screen: "We strongly recommend having a licensed attorney in your state review these documents before signing," with a link to state bar lawyer-referral directories.

UX requirements: one question or one tight group per screen; plain-English tooltips for every legal term; validation at each step; mobile-responsive; estimated time remaining; save-and-exit everywhere.

3.4 Post-Generation

- Dashboard shows document status: *In Progress* → *Ready to Sign* → *Signed (user-confirmed)*.
- Download DOCX/PDF via signed URLs.
- **Execution instructions page** per state: number of witnesses, notarization requirements, self-proving affidavit availability, and a printable checklist.
- Annual reminder email: "Life changes? Update your documents."

- Update flow: subscribed users can reopen the interview with prior answers pre-filled and regenerate.

4. Data Model (Postgres)

```
users          (id, email, created_at, ...)
profiles       (user_id, full_name, state, marital_status, ...)
partners       (id, name, contact, default_package, discount_pct, active)
access_codes   (id, code, partner_id, package, max_uses, uses, expires_at, acti
code_redemptions (id, code_id, user_id, redeemed_at)
subscriptions  (id, user_id, stripe_customer_id, stripe_sub_id, plan, status, c
matters        (id, user_id, doc_type [will|trust], state, status, created_at)
interview_answers (id, matter_id, step_key, answers_jsonb, updated_at)  -- autosa
people         (id, matter_id, role [spouse|child|executor|trustee|guardian|ben
bequests       (id, matter_id, beneficiary_person_id, type [percentage|specific
documents      (id, matter_id, kind [will|trust|pourover|poa|healthcare|hipaa|a
reviews        (FUTURE MODULE — do not build at launch; schema reserved for opt
audit_log      (id, user_id, action, entity, entity_id, ip, created_at)
```

- Row-level security: users see only their own matters/documents; reviewers and admins have role-based elevated access.
- All PII columns encrypted at rest (Supabase default) + application-level encryption for SSN-like fields if ever collected (avoid collecting SSNs at all if possible).

5. The 50-State Legal Engine (critical architecture)

Do **not** hardcode legal rules into templates. Build a **rules layer**:

```
state_rules (state_code, doc_type, rule_key, rule_value, citation, effective_date
```

Rule categories the engine must support:

1. **Execution formalities** — witness count (2 in most states; note Vermont history), witness eligibility (interested-witness rules), notarization (Louisiana requires it for notarial wills), self-proving affidavit availability and statutory form text.
2. **Community property vs. common law** — AZ, CA, ID, LA, NV, NM, TX, WA, WI (+AK/SD/TN opt-in regimes). Affects spousal property characterization language and required acknowledgments.

3. **Spousal elective share / pretermitted heir rules** — surface warnings when a user attempts to disinherit a spouse.
4. **Excluded states at launch (owner-confirmed):** the `excluded_states` list ships with **Louisiana, Texas, North Carolina, Missouri, and Ohio**. Louisiana is excluded for structural reasons (civil-law jurisdiction, forced heirship, distinct will forms); the other four are excluded pending counsel review due to their history of UPL enforcement against document-preparation companies. Excluded states show a “Not yet available in your state” screen with an email-capture waitlist. Build state availability as a per-state admin toggle so any state can be enabled later without a deploy — counsel clearance of TX/NC/MO/OH should be a config change, not a code change.
5. **Electronic wills** — a minority of states permit e-wills (e.g., those adopting the Uniform Electronic Wills Act). **MVP position: all documents are executed with wet signatures.** Store the e-will rule per state so this can be enabled later, and have the builder verify the current list of adopting states at build time via web research rather than trusting a static list.
6. **Trust-specific rules** — trust execution/notarization norms, state trust codes for governing-law clauses.
7. **Ancillary document forms** — many states have **statutory forms** for healthcare directives and POAs. Where a statutory form exists, use it verbatim as the template; where not, use a general attorney-approved form.

Template architecture: one master template per document type with conditional blocks keyed to `state_rules` + interview answers (use a templating layer over the `docx` library, e.g., `docxtemplater`-style merge fields). Every template must carry a version number and be attorney-approved before activation (`template_versions` table with `approved_by` , `approved_at`).

6. Partner Code System

- Admin creates partners; each partner gets code batches (single-use or multi-use with caps, expiration dates, package mapping).
- Code format: human-typeable, e.g., `DFND-XXXX-XXXX` (no ambiguous characters).
- Redemption is atomic (prevent race conditions on `max_uses`).
- Partner reporting dashboard: codes issued/redeemed, matters started/completed, by month. Exportable CSV.

- Codes attribute revenue/usage for internal cross-company accounting.
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7. Admin (Attorney Review = Deferred Future Module)

No attorney review at launch. The platform instead: (a) displays self-help disclaimers throughout, and (b) recommends independent attorney review at the delivery step.

Design the document status model and `reviews` schema so an in-house review offering can be added later as a feature flag without rearchitecting — but write no reviewer UI now.

Admin portal:

- User management, subscription lookup, refund initiation (links to Stripe).
 - Partner & code management (§6).
 - Template version management with approval workflow.
 - State rules editor with citation field and effective dates.
 - Metrics dashboard: signups, conversion, completion rate by interview step (funnel), documents generated by state.
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8. Security & Compliance Requirements

- HTTPS everywhere; HSTS; secure cookies; CSRF protection.
- MFA option for users; **required** for admin/reviewer accounts.
- Signed, expiring URLs for all document downloads; no public buckets.
- Full audit log of document access and admin actions.
- Data retention & deletion policy; user-initiated account deletion flow.
- Rate limiting on auth and code-redemption endpoints.
- **Self-help disclaimers (must appear at signup, throughout the interview footer, and before generation):** "My Defender Will & Trust is not a law firm and does not provide legal advice. Use of this platform does not create an attorney-client relationship. This platform provides self-help document preparation software. We recommend consulting a licensed attorney in your state." *Placeholder language — final wording comes from outside counsel, not the coding model.* Require an

affirmative checkbox acknowledgment before document generation.

- State availability page listing supported/excluded states.
 - Terms of Service and Privacy Policy pages (placeholders for counsel review).
 - Accessibility: WCAG 2.1 AA (this audience skews older).
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9. Phased Build Plan

Phase 0 — Foundations (do first)

- Repo, Next.js + TypeScript + Tailwind + shadcn scaffold, Supabase project, environments (dev/staging/prod), CI with lint + typecheck + tests.
- Data model migrations (§4). Seed script for state_rules with the execution-formality basics for 5 pilot states (TX, CA, FL, NV, AZ).
- **Acceptance:** app boots, auth works, migrations run clean, seed loads.

Phase 1 — Auth, Payments & Codes

- Signup/login/verification/reset; Stripe products + Checkout + webhooks + billing portal; access-code redemption flow with partner attribution; gate screen logic.
- **Acceptance:** a user can subscribe OR redeem a code and land on the dashboard with the correct entitlement; webhook failures retry safely; codes can't be over-redeemed.

Phase 2 — Interview Engine

- Wizard framework (step registry, autosave, resume, validation, progress); implement all steps in §3.3 for **Will** flow; plain-English help content; review-and-edit screen.
- **Acceptance:** full will interview completable on mobile and desktop; refresh mid-interview loses nothing; funnel events logged per step.

Phase 3 — Document Generation (Will, 5 pilot states)

- Template engine + attorney-approvable template versioning; DOCX + PDF output; state execution-instructions pages; document dashboard with statuses; email delivery.
- **Acceptance:** generated will for each pilot state renders correct conditional clauses and correct execution instructions; documents are only downloadable by their

owner.

Phase 4 — Compliance Layer & Membership (launch requirement)

- Self-help disclaimer system with acknowledgment tracking; excluded-state enforcement (LA, TX, NC, MO, OH) + waitlist capture; “find an attorney in your state” recommendation page (links to state bar referral services); **\$49/yr membership as a Stripe subscription with all four launch perks: unlimited updates, secure document vault, annual estate checkup reminder flow, and trust funding tracker.**
- **Acceptance:** excluded states cannot start an interview; every generated document has a logged disclaimer acknowledgment; membership renews/cancels cleanly via billing portal; vault uploads are owner-only via signed URLs; funding tracker persists per matter.

Phase 5 — Trust Flow + Ancillary Documents

- Trust interview branch (deeper asset/funding steps), revocable living trust + pour-over will templates, POA/healthcare directive/HIPAA using statutory forms where they exist; trust **funding instructions** page (retitling guidance checklist).
- **Acceptance:** full trust package generates for pilot states with funding checklist.

Phase 6 — 50-State Rollout

- Populate `state_rules` and template conditionals for remaining states in batches of ~10, each batch verified against current statutes (builder should research current statutory citations, not rely on training data); Louisiana either launches with its own template set or shows “coming soon.”
- **Acceptance:** per-state QA checklist signed off (execution formalities, statutory forms, community-property language) before a state toggles live. States are individually toggleable.

Phase 7 — Admin, Partner Reporting & Polish

- Admin/partner dashboards (§6–7), metrics funnel, annual update reminders, update/regenerate flow, marketing pages, SEO basics, accessibility audit, load testing, penetration-test checklist.
 - **Acceptance:** launch checklist complete.
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10. Instructions to the Coding Model

1. Work phase by phase; do not scaffold everything at once. Complete each acceptance checklist before advancing.
 2. Write tests for: code redemption (concurrency), Stripe webhooks, template rendering per state, and access control on document downloads.
 3. All legal template text, disclaimers, ToS/Privacy content = clearly marked `[ATTORNEY REVIEW REQUIRED]` placeholders. Never present template output as final legal language.
 4. When populating state rules, research current statutes and record the citation and date checked in the `citation` field. Flag anything ambiguous for human review rather than guessing.
 5. Keep the rules layer data-driven — no state-specific `if` statements scattered through templates or code.
 6. Ask the product owner (Dave) before making decisions on: pricing amounts, review-mode defaults, which states launch first beyond the pilot five, and Louisiana strategy.
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11. Open Decisions for the Product Owner

- Which affiliated companies issue codes at launch, and what package/discount each maps to (default is 50% off).
 - Whether couples/mirror documents ship in MVP or Phase 5+.
 - Timing of counsel review to potentially re-enable TX/NC/MO/OH (Texas alone is ~9% of the US population — worth prioritizing).
 - Whether digital legacy / emergency vault access (§12 item 5) joins the membership in a later release.
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12. Membership Perks — CONFIRMED FOR LAUNCH (items 1–4 and 6); item 5 deferred

The \$49/yr membership ships at launch with the following. Recurring value must come from what surrounds the documents:

1. **Unlimited updates** — life changes (marriage, birth, divorce, home purchase) are the natural re-engagement driver; gate post-year-one edits behind membership.
2. **Secure document vault** — encrypted storage for the executed documents plus deeds, insurance policies, account lists.
3. **Annual estate checkup** — guided yearly review flow + reminder emails ("Has anything changed?").
4. **Trust funding tracker** — checklist of assets retitled into the trust, with reminders (high perceived value; trusts fail when unfunded).
5. **Digital legacy / emergency access** — designated person can request access to the vault upon death/incapacity.
6. **Free reprints/shipping** of updated documents.

Later-phase upsells that strengthen a subscription: family plans (parents + adult children), beneficiary-designation review guides, and — if the in-house legal review module ever activates — discounted attorney review as a member perk.